

TUNING IN - Building Curiosity & Prior Knowledge

Tuning In is about sparking curiosity, building engagement, and uncovering what students already know, think, and wonder. Through provocations, discussions, and visible thinking routines, students share prior knowledge and generate questions. Teachers listen closely to student thinking to guide planning and ensure the inquiry is relevant and purposeful. This stage sets the foundation for the entire inquiry by creating excitement, establishing connections to students' lives, and introducing key concepts in an engaging and meaningful way.

Possible Activities:

- ☐ **Wonder Wall:** Students write questions on sticky notes and place them on a class display. The class groups similar questions and revisits them throughout the unit to guide learning and track curiosity.
- ☐ **Think-Pair-Share:** Students think about a prompt, discuss their ideas with a partner, then share with the class to build confidence and activate prior knowledge.
- ☐ **Chalk Talk:** Students respond silently to a question written on large paper, adding ideas and comments to others' responses to build shared understanding without verbal discussion.
- ☐ **Provocation (image/video/object):** Students observe a carefully selected stimulus and share what they notice, think, and wonder to spark curiosity and introduce the inquiry concept.
- ☐ **KWL Chart:** Students record what they already know and what they want to learn, then revisit the chart during the unit to track new understanding.
- ☐ **Sorting Pictures/Artifacts:** Students group images or objects based on their own criteria and explain their reasoning to reveal prior knowledge and different perspectives.
- ☐ **Concept Cartoon Discussion:** Students examine a cartoon showing different viewpoints and discuss which ideas they agree with, justifying their thinking.
- ☐ **Four Corners Opinion:** Students move to different areas of the room based on their opinion and explain their thinking to explore different perspectives.
- ☐ **Draw & Label Thinking:** Students draw what they know about a topic and label key ideas to visually represent their understanding.
- ☐ **Question Burst:** Students generate as many questions as possible about a topic in a short time, focusing on curiosity rather than answers.
- ☐ **Story Hook:** Students listen to or view a story connected to the inquiry and discuss key ideas, connections, and questions that arise.
- ☐ **Role Play Scenario:** Students act out a real-life situation related to the inquiry to explore perspectives and deepen engagement.
- ☐ **Gallery Walk:** Students move around the room viewing images, texts, or objects and record their thoughts or questions at each station.
- ☐ **Brain Dump:** Students quickly write or draw everything they already know about a topic to reveal prior knowledge and misconceptions.
- ☐ **Prediction Activity:** Students make predictions about what they think will happen or what they might learn, then revisit these predictions later.

FINDING OUT - Gathering Information

Finding Out focuses on building new knowledge and developing research skills. Students gather information through a variety of sources such as texts, experiments, experts, and digital tools. They learn how to ask questions, locate information, and record their findings in organised ways. Teachers scaffold this process to support independence and critical thinking. This stage ensures students are exposed to rich, varied experiences that deepen understanding and provide the information needed to explore the inquiry in greater depth.

Possible Activities:

- ☐ **Research Stations:** Students rotate through different stations with books, videos, and images, recording key information at each to build understanding from multiple sources.
- ☐ **Guided Research:** The teacher models how to find and record information, then supports students to practise these skills using structured templates.
- ☐ **Note-Taking Scaffold:** Students use a provided template (headings, boxes, diagrams) to organise and record important information from their research.
- ☐ **Experiment/Investigation:** Students carry out a hands-on investigation, observe what happens, and record results to help answer inquiry questions.
- ☐ **Guest Speaker/Expert:** Students prepare questions, listen to an expert, and record key information to deepen understanding.
- ☐ **Excursion/Incursion/Virtual Tour:** Students explore a real or virtual environment, recording observations, questions, and new learning.
- ☐ **Survey/Interview:** Students ask questions to peers or others, collect responses, and record findings to explore different perspectives.
- ☐ **Video Analysis:** Students watch a video and record important facts, ideas, or questions related to the inquiry.
- ☐ **Reading for Information:** Students read non-fiction texts and identify key facts or ideas to support their understanding.
- ☐ **Image Analysis:** Students examine images or diagrams and discuss what they notice, think, and wonder to gather information.
- ☐ **Web Search Skills Lesson:** Students learn how to search safely online, using key words and evaluating reliable sources.
- ☐ **Shared Experience:** The class participates in a common activity (e.g. experiment or simulation) to build shared understanding.
- ☐ **Listening to Podcasts/Stories:** Students listen to audio texts and record important information or ideas.
- ☐ **Data Collection Task:** Students gather measurable or observable data and record it in tables, charts, or notes.
- ☐ **Question-Driven Research:** Students select a question and research to find answers, recording relevant information.

SORTING OUT - Making Meaning

Sorting Out is where students make sense of what they have learned. They organise, analyse, and connect information to develop deeper understanding. Through discussions, visual organisers, and reflective thinking, students identify patterns, clarify ideas, and revisit their initial thinking. This stage supports the development of critical thinking as students move beyond gathering facts to building meaningful connections and generalisations. It helps students consolidate their learning and prepares them to apply their understanding in more complex ways.

Possible Activities:

- ☐ **Mind Mapping:** Students organise ideas around a central concept, showing connections between key ideas.
- ☐ **Venn Diagram:** Students compare two or more ideas, identifying similarities and differences.
- ☐ **Cause & Effect Chart:** Students identify actions and their outcomes to understand relationships between ideas.
- ☐ **Concept Mapping:** Students connect ideas using linking words to show relationships between concepts.
- ☐ **Class Discussion:** Students share ideas, ask questions, and build on each other's thinking to deepen understanding.
- ☐ **Revisit KWL:** Students update what they have learned and reflect on how their thinking has changed.
- ☐ **Generalisation Statements:** Students write broad statements that summarise key understandings from their learning.
- ☐ **Role Play/Drama:** Students act out scenarios to demonstrate their understanding of concepts or perspectives.
- ☐ **Data Representation:** Students organise information into graphs, charts, or tables to identify patterns.
- ☐ **De Bono Thinking Hats:** Students explore ideas from different perspectives (e.g. feelings, facts, risks, creativity).
- ☐ **Compare & Contrast Writing:** Students write about similarities and differences between concepts or ideas.
- ☐ **Analogy Creation:** Students explain new ideas by comparing them to familiar concepts.
- ☐ **Diagram Creation:** Students draw labelled diagrams to represent their understanding.
- ☐ **True/False Justification:** Students decide if statements are true or false and explain their reasoning using evidence.
- ☐ **Peer Teaching:** Students explain their understanding to others to reinforce learning.

GOING FURTHER - Deepening & Personalising

Going Further allows students to deepen and personalise their learning by pursuing their own questions and interests. Students work more independently or collaboratively to investigate topics in greater depth, often choosing how they learn and present their understanding. This stage promotes student agency, creativity, and ownership of learning. Teachers provide support and structure while allowing flexibility for students to explore new ideas, extend their thinking, and engage in meaningful, self-directed inquiry.

Possible Activities:

- ☐ **Independent Inquiry Project:** Students investigate a self-chosen question and present their findings in a chosen format.
- ☐ **Small Group Inquiry:** Students work collaboratively to explore a shared question or interest.
- ☐ **Inquiry Contracts:** Students select tasks from a choice board and complete them over time with increasing independence.
- ☐ **Wonder Wall Follow-Up:** Students choose a question from the Wonder Wall and investigate it further.
- ☐ **Expert Groups (Jigsaw):** Students become experts on one topic and teach their knowledge to others.
- ☐ **Learning Centres:** Students rotate through activities that extend different aspects of the inquiry.
- ☐ **Passion Project:** Students explore a topic they are personally interested in and create a project to share learning.
- ☐ **Alternative Research:** Students use new or contrasting sources to deepen or challenge their understanding.
- ☐ **Problem Solving Task:** Students design solutions to a real-world problem related to the inquiry.
- ☐ **Global Sharing:** Students share their ideas online and connect with a wider audience.
- ☐ **Creative Project Design:** Students choose how to represent their learning (e.g. model, video, poster).
- ☐ **Deep Question Investigation:** Students explore complex questions that require deeper thinking and research.
- ☐ **Peer Collaboration Task:** Students work together to co-create a shared product or response.
- ☐ **Extension Challenges:** Students complete higher-level tasks that require critical or creative thinking.
- ☐ **Choice Boards:** Students select tasks based on their interests and readiness level.

REFLECTION & ACTION - Applying & Growing

Reflection & Action is where students consolidate their learning, reflect on their growth, and apply their understanding in meaningful ways. Students evaluate what they have learned, how their thinking has changed, and what they can do next. They share their learning with others and may take action to make a difference in their community. This stage builds metacognition, encourages responsibility, and empowers students to see themselves as capable learners who can use their knowledge to create positive change.

Possible Activities:

- ☐ **Learning Journal:** Students regularly record what they learned, how they learned, and questions they still have.
- ☐ **Self-Assessment Rubric:** Students assess their work against clear criteria and identify areas for improvement.
- ☐ **Peer Feedback:** Students give constructive feedback to peers to help improve learning.
- ☐ **“I Used to Think...” Routine:** Students reflect on how their thinking has changed over time.
- ☐ **Goal Setting:** Students set personal learning goals based on their progress.
- ☐ **Presentation/Showcase:** Students share their learning with an audience through presentations or displays.
- ☐ **Teaching Others:** Students teach their learning to peers or younger students to reinforce understanding.
- ☐ **Action Project:** Students apply learning to make a positive change in their school or community.
- ☐ **Create Persuasive Texts:** Students create texts to encourage others to think or act differently.
- ☐ **Model/Prototype Creation:** Students design and build a representation or solution to a problem.
- ☐ **Portfolio Compilation:** Students collect and reflect on work samples to show growth over time.
- ☐ **Reflection Discussion:** Students participate in class discussions about what and how they learned.
- ☐ **Revisit Inquiry Questions:** Students review initial questions and evaluate how they have been answered.
- ☐ **Personal Action Plan:** Students plan how they will use their learning in real-life situations.
- ☐ **Celebration of Learning:** Students share and celebrate their achievements and growth with others.